REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS

Rising Roots Black Futures Fund: 2027 Request for Proposals

Competitive grant · Opens December 1, 2026

At a glance

Funding: $2,500 to $10,000

Type of support: Project or general operating support

Term: One year, beginning April 1, 2027

Total available: Approximately $90,000

Geographic eligibility: Applications are accepted from organizations serving communities anywhere in Arizona.

Program page: https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/grants/rising-roots-black-futures-fund/

About the program

The Rising Roots Black Futures Fund was launched in 2021 by Black philanthropists in northern Arizona who wanted to increase investment in Black-led organizations and preserve the history of Black communities in the region, including the families who built Flagstaff's railroad and lumber industries.

Grants support Black-led nonprofits and grassroots groups statewide. First-time applicants and organizations with annual budgets under $250,000 are especially encouraged to apply.

Focus and impact areas

Focus areas: Black Futures.

We welcome proposals that address one or more of the following impact areas:

- Community and economic development in Black communities
- Black artistic expression and preservation of cultural heritage
- Financial literacy, homeownership, and entrepreneurship
- Black youth leadership and educational achievement

Populations served

- Black residents and families in Arizona
- Black youth and students
- Black entrepreneurs and small business owners
- Black artists and historians

Eligibility

Geographic eligibility

Applications are accepted from organizations serving communities anywhere in Arizona.

Who may apply

- Black-led 501(c)(3) organizations, or Black-led projects and grassroots groups with a qualified fiscal sponsor
- Organizations not Black-led may apply for programs designed with and for Black communities, documented by a letter of partnership
- Serves Black communities in Arizona
- One application per organization per year

What we do not fund

- Individuals or scholarships
- Religious activities
- Capital campaigns or endowments
- Lobbying or partisan political activity

Funding

$2,500 to $10,000. Project or general operating support.

Key dates

Milestone	Date
Application period opens	Tuesday, December 1, 2026
Application deadline	Friday, January 29, 2027, 5:00 p.m. MST
Decision	Applicants notified by March 12, 2027
Grant period	April 1, 2027 – March 31, 2028

How to apply

Rising Roots uses a short, single-stage application. Applicants may submit written answers or a video of up to ten minutes.

1. **Read the RFP.** Download the Rising Roots Black Futures Fund 2027 Request for Proposals.
2. **Prepare the application.** Draft answers to the five application questions listed in the RFP, or record a video response.
3. **Submit.** Submit through the CPCF Grant Portal, or email materials to grants@cinderpeakscf.org with the subject line "Rising Roots – [Organization Name]", by 5:00 p.m. MST on January 29, 2027.

4. **Decision.** The Rising Roots Advisory Circle reviews applications in February. Applicants are notified by March 12, 2027.

Application questions

1. Tell us about your organization and the Black community you serve.
2. What do you want to accomplish with this grant, and why now?
3. Who will lead the work, and how is the community involved?
4. How will you know the work has made a difference?
5. How will the grant be spent? Include a simple budget.

Review criteria

- Black leadership and community accountability
- Alignment with fund priorities
- Potential for lasting benefit to Black communities
- Feasibility of the plan and budget

Reporting requirements

Grantees submit a Community Impact Story Report at the end of the grant year.

- A short narrative, photo, or video story describing results
- Number of people served
- Permission for public sharing

Due: April 30, 2028.

Templates and supporting documents

- **Grant Project Budget Template:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-grant-project-budget-template.pdf
- **Fiscal Sponsor Letter Template:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-fiscal-sponsor-letter-template.pdf
- **Community Impact Story Report Form:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/reporting/cpcf-community-impact-story-report-form.pdf

Questions?

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